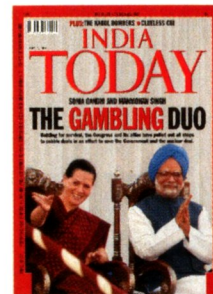
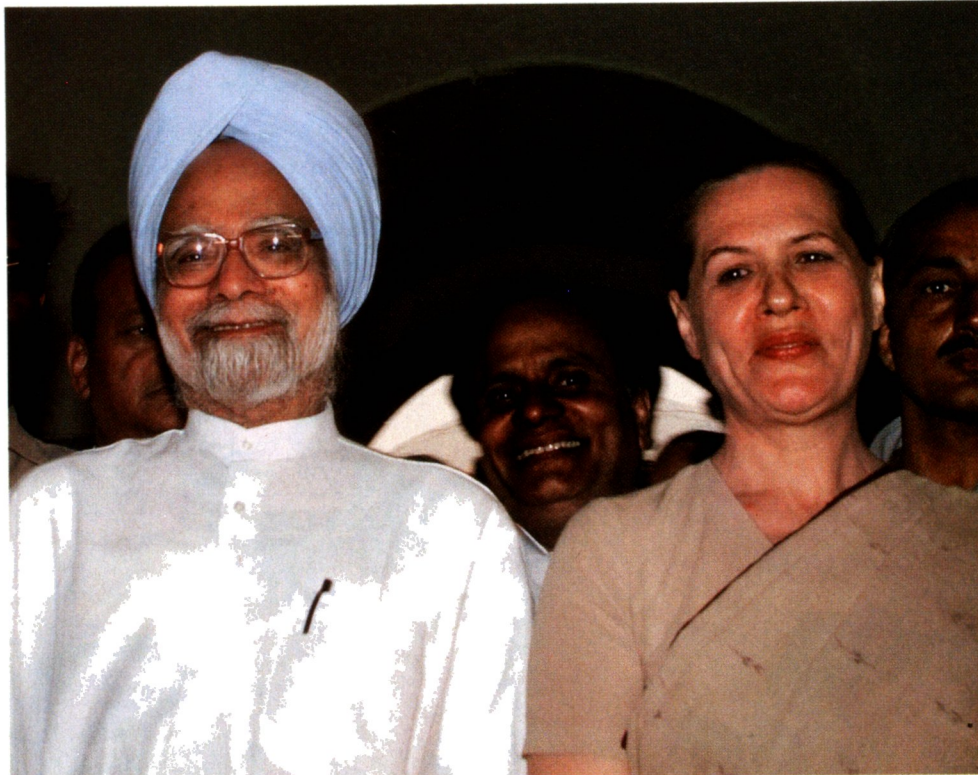


AFP



"The Gambling Duo",
July 21, 2008

"Politicians have joined hands to remain in power. They have put aside their lofty ideologies and adopted unscrupulous means to retain their chairs."

M. KUMAR, on e-mail

Left, Right, Left

The nuclear deal has exposed the self-serving character of the political class once again. Every party is looking at it through the prism of electoral gains and not its relevance ("The Gambling Duo", July 21). The sudden change of sides by the Samajwadi Party and the hard deals to gain MPs' votes make a mockery of strategic significance of the Indo-US agreement and portray sordid cupidity of the people's representatives.
Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

The Left's justification of the alliance as a tactical move to keep "communal forces" out of power was, and remains, no more than bunkum ("Blind Left Turn", July 21). It wanted power without responsibility, so extended support to the Congress-led UPA Government. Now that

the Left is being denied that power, it sees no point in remaining with the Congress.
J.S. ACHARYA, Hyderabad

The Left did not hesitate to communalise the nuclear deal issue while the likes of BJP and BSP went out of their way to show their lust for power. Whether the Congress-led UPA Government remains or goes, it will have little effect on the misfortunes of the common man, who will still have to bear the brunt of this political turmoil and the menace of rising prices. Is there any way these politicians can put people's interest above their own?
S.P. ASHTA, on e-mail

The Left is evidently stunting India's growth by opposing the nuclear agreement ("Securing the Future", July 21). The political opportunists with their obsolete ideologies

are not only destabilising the Government but are also thwarting our nation's long-term development plans.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, Bangalore

The Indo-US nuclear deal is serving political interests in more than one way ("The M Factor", July 21) with Mayawati and her ilk flagrantly dubbing it anti-Muslim. It is obviously for some unprincipled miscalculated political gains, but they need to realise that rotten idiosyncrasy may cause ignominy.
INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

The communist ideology, long given up by nations, including China and Russia, is being followed by our comrades in the CPI(M), CPI and other Left parties. No wonder, they have failed to leave a mark outside their strongholds in Kerala, Tripura and West Bengal.

The Left parties should abandon their outdated ideology and work with the mainstream parties to usher in economic reforms which have catapulted nations like China to the forefront of super economic powers.
D.B.N. MURTHY, on e-mail

Green Mile

Global warming is nothing less than global warning ("Global Warming", July 14). People are aware of the problem but unfortunately, they do not have the perfect know-how to solve it. Environmental activists and NGOs should come forward to create awareness among the masses. It is the most effective means to combat this issue.
NAZNEEN O. SAHERWALA, Surat

Nation Comes Last

If the influx of Bangladeshi migrants continues unabated, Assam would become a